

Session 1: Introduction to SaaS and CRM

What is SaaS?

Software as a Service (SaaS) is a business model in which customers pay to access and use cloud hosted software over the Internet rather than purchasing it. It is different from a traditional software that has to be purchased and installed locally.

Benefits :-

Cost Effectiveness - Reduces or eliminates initial infrastructure investment.

Scalability and flexibility - Users can easily scale subscription up or down based on business needs and demands.

Security and Reliability - SaaS offers high level security, backups.

Automatic Updates and Maintenance - Vendors handle all software updates, maintenance, reduces its workload.

Example for SaaS :-

Google Docs is an example of SaaS because:

- * It's a ready-to-use software accessed through a web browser without installation.
- * Google manages all infrastructure, updates and security, not the user.
- * Users can only create and edit documents thus making it a SaaS.

CRM (Customer Relationship Management)

It's a system for managing all of your company's interaction with current and ~~past~~ potential customers. It helps companies stay connected to customers, streamline process and improve profitability.

Why is CRM important?

- * It turns scattered customer data into a single, reliable system that teams ~~can~~ use to sell more, serve better and grow faster.
- * CRM improves organization, personalization and follow-up at scale.
- * It improves productivity and automation.
- * Cross-departmental collaboration becomes easy.

→ Hubspot CRM is an example for CRM software.

→ How business use CRM to manage customer relationships and sales?

- * CRM's are used to store contact, sales and purchase info.
- * Teams can use CRM to visually track lead, manage ~~offer~~ opportunities, and move potential buyers through the sales journey.
- * Support teams use CRM's to manage tickets, ~~see~~ review past interaction and resolve issues faster which improves customer satisfaction.

→ Key CRM features

- ↳ Contacts - Centralization of database is done to store and manage customer details, interaction history, and communication records.
- ↳ Deals - Tracks sales opportunities from lead to closure including value, stage and probability.
- ↳ Pipelines - Visual working flow showing stages of sales process.
- ↳ Automation - Automates repetitive tasks like follow-ups, email sending, lead assignment and reminders using predefined rules.

CRM as Cloud-based SaaS

A CRM runs on the vendor's cloud server and is accessed via browser or app. No local installation is done. User log in online, data is stored centrally, updates and maintenance are handled by the provider.

→ Multi-tenancy in SaaS.

Multi-tenancy means a single CRM application instance serves multiple organizations (tenants) while keeping their data isolated.

Benefits

- i) Lower cost (shared infrastructure)
- ii) Easy scalability
- iii) Automatic updates for all users
- iv) ~~Easy~~ Faster deployment without separate installations